

River Fox *Events*

A REFERENCE FOR DESIGN, COPY & VOICE

Considered, design-led event styling — Surrey, the South East and London. This book is the single source of truth for how the brand looks, sounds and behaves across every page, image and conversation.

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CHAPTER 01

Considered, *design-led*, calm.

River Fox Events is Laura Hyde's luxury event styling studio in Surrey. Balloon installations, backdrops, signage, light-up letters, props and tablescape architecture for milestone moments — christenings, big birthdays, anniversaries, weddings, corporate launches and brand activations.

A • WHAT WE PROMISE

A room that feels considered the moment guests walk in.

Scale and palette held together by one designer's eye, executed with the calm of someone who has done it before. Hosts get something quietly extraordinary — never punchy, never novelty-led.

B • WHO WE SERVE

Milestones, mostly.

- Children's parties — first birthdays through to teenage milestones
- Milestone celebrations — 30ths, 40ths, 50ths, 60ths and beyond
- Weddings, christenings, baby showers
- Corporate & brand styling, award nights, product launches, shopfronts
- Luxury picnics & outdoor occasions

Three things we hold to.

-
- 01 **Design-led.** Every brief begins with a render board — palette, scale and sightlines decided before a single balloon is inflated.
-
- 02 **Quiet luxury.** Pastel and neutral palettes, generous scale, restraint. Never loud. Never themed for the sake of theme.
-
- 03 **Calmly delivered.** Install morning is steady, not frantic. Hosts hand over the day and stop worrying about it.
-

From Lollipop Balloons to River Fox.

River Fox Events is the rebrand of Lollipop Balloons — the same designer, same inventory, more grown-up positioning. The historic name is preserved in JSON-LD as `alternateName` so legacy links and brand searches keep flowing through. Don't bury the heritage; don't lead with it either.

CHAPTER 02

Quietly *authoritative.*

Laura speaks as the designer, in first person, with the calm of someone who has done it before. Sentences earn their length. Sensory detail does the work that adjectives can't.

A · SIX RULES

How Laura sounds.

- 01 **First person, quietly authoritative.** "I want the family to be able to read it in seconds." Not "we" — Laura speaks as the designer.
- 02 **Short, specific, occasionally fragmentary.** "Beautiful bones, very little atmosphere." A two-word sentence is fine when the moment calls for it.
- 03 **Sensory detail over adjectives.** Name the actual thing — "pink scallop-edge plates, a soft zebra-print salad plate on top" — not "beautiful tablescape".
- 04 **Trade-craft language used naturally.** Sightlines, scale, the brief, sourcing, install morning, sign-off, render board. Trust the reader to keep up.
- 05 **Em dashes welcome. Exclamation marks never.** Use the em dash to slow a sentence down, not the exclamation to speed it up.
- 06 **Quiet expertise, never sales.** Explain *why* a choice was made; don't tell the reader it was excellent.

Same voice, different rooms.

SURFACE	TONE	LENGTH
Hero headline	Considered, image-forward	4–8 words
Section body	Calm, descriptive, design-led	2–4 sentence paragraphs
Journal article	First-person Laura, sensory, reflective	900–1300 words
Form labels	Direct, unadorned	1–3 words, uppercase mono
CTAs	Invitational, never urgent	"Start planning →"
Email reply / DM	Warm, prompt, professional	3–5 lines
Instagram caption	Quietly confident, one design observation	2–4 lines

Calm, considered, *design-led*. Never punchy, never salesy.

CHAPTER 03

Say this, *not that.*

A • BANNED

Never use.

Filler phrases and adjective-led praise that say nothing about the work. Strip on sight.

~~If you're looking for...~~ • ~~Look no further...~~ • ~~We pride ourselves on...~~ • ~~Our team of experts...~~ • ~~The perfect party~~ • ~~Stunning~~ • ~~Amazing~~ • ~~Wow factor~~ • ~~Show-stopping~~ • ~~Exclamation marks~~

B • CAPPED — RESTRAINT

Use, but rarely.

- **Bespoke** — banned from titles, max once per meta description
- **Luxury** — max twice across all page titles site-wide
- **From £460** — appears in max six page metas site-wide

C • PREFERRED — HOUSE LANGUAGE

The trade-craft we like.

Considered • Design-led • Calm • Restraint • Render board • Sightlines • Scale • Install morning • Sign-off • The brief • Sourcing • Tablescape • Threshold piece • Pastel & neutral • Milestone

Don't, then do.

D O N ' T

"If you're looking for the perfect party, look no further — our team of experts will create a stunning, show-stopping event!"

Filler stack, adjective-led praise, exclamation. Says nothing about the work. Sounds like every other party stylist.

D O N ' T

"We're so excited to share this amazing styling we did last weekend!"

"We" instead of Laura. "Amazing" carries no information. Reads like a sales post, not a designer's note.

D O

"A pastel palette, a 4m balloon install above the cake table, and a banquet of ten — held together by one designer's eye."

Sensory specifics. Names the actual moves. Quietly states scale without claiming "wow factor".

D O

"Beautiful bones, very little atmosphere — a Cobham garden room asking for scale and a softer palette."

Diagnoses the venue. Names the design tension. Reader can already picture the answer.

CHAPTER 04

What we *do*. What we don't.

Two filters protect the brand: the work we'll publish images of, and the inventory we actually supply. If a topic needs an out-of-scope item to land, the topic is wrong — pick a different one.

A • AUTO-REJECT

Never published.

- Soft play setups
- Mascot or costume-character appearances
- Disco lights, smoke machines, club-style lighting rigs
- Phone parties / mobile gaming-truck parties
- Plastic novelty tat, party-shop bunting, off-the-shelf themed kits
- Anything cheap-feeling, punchy or novelty-led

B • DISCOURAGED BUT ALLOWED

Range extension, not the house style.

Only published when there's a real, photographed event behind it — and the design moves (palette, scale, restraint) lead, not the IP. Aim for ≤ 1 in 6 articles in this bucket.

- Character themes — Bluey, Mario, Disney, Paw Patrol, etc.
- Neon palettes & brighter colour schemes

The territory.

- Pastel and neutral palettes
- Large-scale installs (4m+ backdrops, banquet tables of 10+)
- Tablescape-led design
- Milestone moments — christenings, big birthdays, anniversaries, baby showers, corporate
- Render-led process pieces
- Named real venues in Surrey, the South East and London

CHAPTER 04 • CONTINUED

Laura's *toolkit*.

The canonical in-and-out list. Articles, image direction and design-move language must build only from the IN list. If a topic needs an OUT item to land, the topic is wrong — pick another.

A • IN — LAURA SUPPLIES

In scope.

- **Balloons** — arches, garlands, walls, hoops, towers, organic installs, centrepieces, threshold pieces, number stacks, jumbo & helium
- **Backdrops** — fabric, sailboard (custom-painted with vinyl), themed photo walls, sequin walls, full themed installations
- **Signage** — painted boards, vinyl & acrylic stickers on board, life-size cardboard cutouts, personalised acrylic and foam signs, custom welcome signs (weatherproof variants)
- **Light-up letters & numbers**, number stacks
- **Up-lighters** — including waterproof for outdoor
- **Themed props** — 3D acrylic, plinths, risers, cake stands (NOT the cake)
- **Faux florals** — sparingly, as texture, never the headline
- **Textiles** — muslin, cheesecloth, drapery, linens, chair sashes & covers
- **Soft seats, low tables, cushions** — kids' setups, picnics

Out of scope.

- Fresh florals, fresh foliage, any compositional flower-arranging
 - Vessels, glassware, vintage stoneware (the curated-tablescape category)
 - Candles or candle-holders
 - The cake itself (cake stands only)
 - Catering, food, drink, bar service
-

Laura is not a florist.

Never lead a design move with florals — fresh or faux. Faux stems are a quiet prop, never the subject of an image, headline, pull quote or section title. If anything flower-shaped appears on her displays, it's faux, ambient, and never the focal point.

If a topic seems to need florals to land, the topic is wrong for Laura — *pick a different one.*

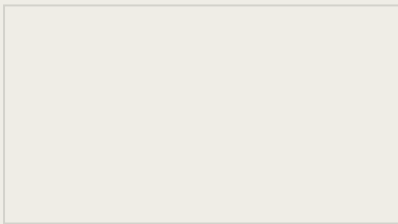
CHAPTER 05

Moss, cream & *soft peach.*

All colours are specified as HSL in code. The hex values below are for Figma. Never use pure black — the brand ink is a softened charcoal.

A • SURFACES

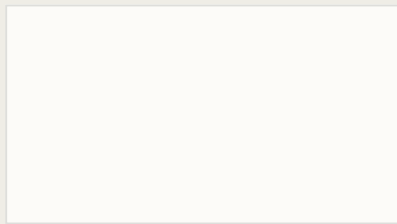
Backgrounds.

**Background — cream**

#EFEDE6

hsl(47 22% 92%)

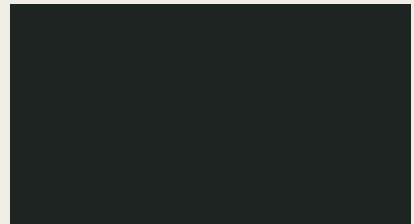
Page background. Primary canvas.

**Surface alt — warm white**

#FCFBF8

hsl(45 36% 98%)

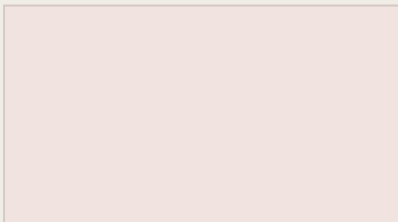
Cards, form wrap, popovers.

**Surface deep — moss black**

#1E2421

hsl(144 9% 13%)

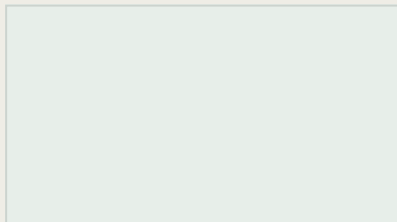
Dark sections, footer, enquire band.

**Surface warm — peach tint**

#F1E3DF

hsl(14 38% 91%)

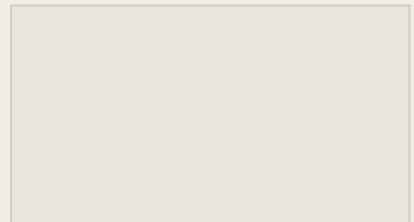
Soft warm section background.

**Surface blush — sage tint**

#E7EEE9

hsl(137 18% 92%)

Soft sage section background.

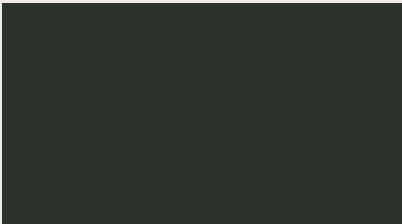
**On-deep — text on dark**

#E9E6DD

hsl(47 22% 89%)

Body copy on surface deep.

Text.

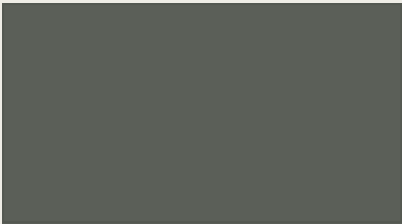


Ink — primary

#2B312B

hsl(120 6% 18%)

Headlines & body. Softened charcoal — never pure black.

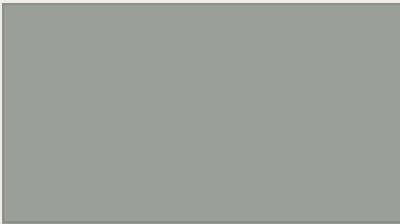


Ink soft — meta

#5B5F58

hsl(100 4% 36%)

Eyebrows, captions, secondary copy.



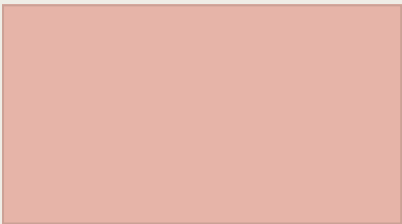
Ink faint — placeholder

#9AA098

hsl(100 4% 61%)

Form placeholders, disabled states.

Highlights.

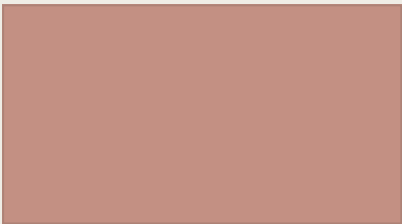


Accent — soft peach

#E6B4A8

hsl(12 55% 78%)

Primary CTA fill, focus ring.

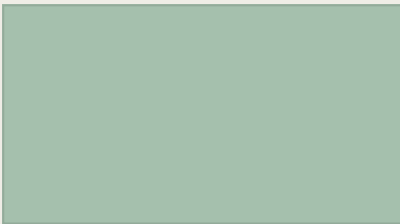


Accent warm — dusty peach

#C39083

hsl(12 35% 64%)

Italic highlights, ticker glyphs.



Accent soft — sage

#A5C0AD

hsl(137 18% 70%)

Secondary accent. Use sparingly.

CHAPTER 06

Fraunces · DM Sans

JetBrains Mono.

A · THE THREE FAMILIES

What each one is for.

Aa

Fraunces

Display serif — headlines, hero, pull-quotes, italic highlights.

Weights: 300, 400, 500 (italics 300, 400).

Default 300 with letter-spacing
-0.015em.

Aa

DM Sans

UI sans — body, buttons, nav, form inputs.

Weights: 300, 400, 500, 600.

Body baseline: 15px / line-height 1.55.

Aa

JetBrains Mono

Mono — eyebrows, labels, meta.

Weight: 400 (occasional 500/600).

Always uppercase, letter-spacing
0.18–0.22em.

Sizes in use.

HERO H1

Considered
styling

FRAUNCES 300 ·
CLAMP(56-120PX) · 7VW

H2 SECTION

Children's parties

FRAUNCES 300 ·
CLAMP(40-80PX) ·
~4.2VW

H3 SUBHEAD

A note on faux florals

FRAUNCES 500 · 26-
34PX

REVEAL QUOTE

made to *linger*

FRAUNCES 300 · 56-
200PX

BODY

Calm, considered, design-led — the tone we hold
across every page.

DM SANS 400 · 15PX

ARTICLE H2

When the garden is the venue

FRAUNCES 500 · 26-
34PX

EYEBROW

CHILDREN'S PARTIES · 01

MONO 400 · 11PX ·
0.18EM

FORM LABEL

YOUR NAME

MONO 600 · 9.5PX ·
0.22EM

NAV LINK

Children's parties

DM SANS 400 · 13PX

BUTTON

Start planning →

DM SANS 500 · 13PX

CHAPTER 07

Generous space. Tight *rhythm*.

A · CONTAINERS & SECTIONS

The page frame.

TOKEN	VALUE	USAGE
container max	1440px	Max page width
container padding	56px · 32px @960 · 28px @640	Horizontal padding
section padding (desktop)	120px 0	Default vertical rhythm
section padding (1024+)	96px 0	Mid-desktop tighter rhythm
section padding (mobile)	56px 0	≤760px
laptop section	80px 0	768–1366px
nav padding	14px 56px 18px	Fixed top nav
scroll-padding-top	80px	Anchor offset (mobile / tablet)

Tailwind defaults — used as-is.

space-1	4px	
space-2	8px	
space-3	12px	
space-4	16px	
space-6	24px	
space-8	32px	
space-12	48px	
space-14	56px	
space-20	80px	
space-24	96px	
space-30	120px	

Roundedness.

TOKEN	VALUE	USAGE
radius-sm	4px	Tight chips, hairline elements
radius-md	6px	Buttons
radius-lg	8px	Default — cards
form-row	10px	Form input rows
form-wrap	14px · 12px mobile	Enquire form container
image (mobile)	12px	Editorial reveal images on phones
pill	9999px	Status dots, chips

Where the layout shifts.

NAME	RANGE	NOTES
Mobile	≤ 640px	Container 28px · sections 56px · body bumps 17.5px
Tablet	641 – 760px	Stack to single column · image first in reveals
Laptop	768 – 1366px	Container 8vw · sections 80px · hero h1 ≤ 72px
Desktop	≥ 1367px	Container 56px · max 1440px · sections 120px

CHAPTER 08

Editorial, natural *light*.

A • HOUSE STYLE

The visual anchor.

Photorealistic editorial event styling photography, soft natural daylight, pastel and neutral palette, considered composition, balloon installations and tablescapes in real UK venue interiors, no people or faces, no text, no logos, shot on medium format with shallow depth of field.

B • SUBJECT & COMPOSITION

What's in the frame.

- Lead with installations Laura actually supplies — balloons, backdrops, signage, light-up letters, plinths, tablescape props
- Faux florals can sit in frame as quiet texture, never as the subject
- Subject centred so a square or 4:3 crop still leads with the subject (hero strips and OG cards crop hard)
- No people, no faces, no logos, no on-image text
- Natural daylight feel even when retouched. Shadows soft, never theatrical

What to ship.

USE	FORMAT · SIZE	MAX KB	LOADING
Hero	WebP · 1600×900	500 KB	eager · fetchpriority high
Gallery / supporting	WebP · ~1200px wide	200 KB	lazy
Thumbnail	WebP · 800×800	100 KB	lazy
OG card	WebP · 1200×630	200 KB	—

Lossy WebP at quality 75–85. srcset with at least three sizes so smaller viewports don't pull the desktop file.

One image, one filename, one alt.

- The rule is per *file*, not per placement
- Filename describes content, not the page topic — `cobham-balloon-arch-pastel.webp`, not `journal-image-1.webp`
- Alt text describes what's *in* the image, not the page or the brand. Max 125 characters
- Two different files must not open their alt with the same five words
- Each page needs a per-page OG image in `public/og/` overriding the global fallback

Alt text — don't, then do.

DON'T

"Children's party styling in Surrey by River Fox Events"

Brand-led, page-led, says nothing about the photo.
Repeated across files = duplicate content.

DO

"Pastel balloon arch over a long banquet table set with pink scallop-edge plates, Cobham garden room"

Names the actual subject, palette and venue. Each photo gets its own specific alt.

CHAPTER 09

Studio, contact, *the small print.*

A · THE BRAND

Who we are, on paper.

Brand name	River Fox Events
Alternate name	Lollipop Balloons (preserved in JSON-LD <code>alternateName</code>)
Founder & stylist	Laura Hyde
Brand & web design	Matthew Luxford
Studio	15 Apsley Rd, Horley, RH6 9RX
Service area	Surrey · South East · London
Pricing anchor	Events from £460 (use this number consistently)

B · CONTACT

How people reach us.

Phone	07872 114191
Email	riverfoxevents@gmail.com
Instagram	@lollipop_balloonsx — historic handle, still active
Website	riverfoxevents.co.uk
Never use	hello@riverfoxevents.co.uk — that address does not exist

The small punctuation rules.

Em dash	— (preferred for slowing a sentence)
En dash	– (number ranges only: 900–1300 words)
Curly quotes	"like this" — never "straight"
Apostrophe	Children's, not Children's
Exclamation marks	Never
Pricing	"from £460" (lowercase "from", no space)
Town & venue names	Always real, always spelled correctly

Made to *linger* — long after the guests have gone home.